



Western Australian Certificate of Education Examination, 2009

Question/Answer Booklet

PSYCHOLOGY

Stage 3

Please place your student identification label in this box

Student Number: In figures

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In words

Time allowed for this paper

Reading/planning time before commencing work: ten minutes
Working time for paper: three hours

Materials required/recommended for this paper

To be provided by the supervisor

This Question/Answer Booklet

To be provided by the candidate

Standard items: pens, pencils, eraser, correction fluid, ruler, highlighters

Special items: calculators satisfying the conditions set by the Curriculum Council for this course

Important note to candidates

No other materials may be taken into the examination room. It is **your** responsibility to ensure that you do not have any unauthorised notes or other material of a non-personal nature in the examination room. If you have any unauthorised material with you, hand it to the supervisor **before** reading any further.



Section One: Research Methods

20 Marks

This section has **three (3)** questions. Attempt **all** questions.

Suggested working time: 30 minutes

Question 1

(6 marks)

A researcher conducted an experiment to measure the effect of caffeine on a person's ability to complete a jigsaw puzzle.

One hundred university students aged between 20 and 25 years were randomly selected and allocated to one of two groups. The experiment was conducted over one day.

Group 1 consumed a caffeine-based drink. Group 2 consumed a non-caffeine-based drink. After 30 minutes, participants from both groups were given the same simple jigsaw puzzle to complete. Participants were timed for this activity.

The results are as follows:

Group 1	caffeine group	10 seconds (mean score)
Group 2	non-caffeine group	16 seconds (mean score)

A statistical test on the difference between the two mean scores for Group 1 and Group 2 found that $p > 0.05$.

- (a) State the **hypothesis** the researcher could develop for this study. (1 mark)

- (b) Identify:

- (i) the **independent** variable for this study. (1 mark)

- (ii) the **dependent** variable for this study. (1 mark)



- (c) State the conclusions the researcher could draw from the results.

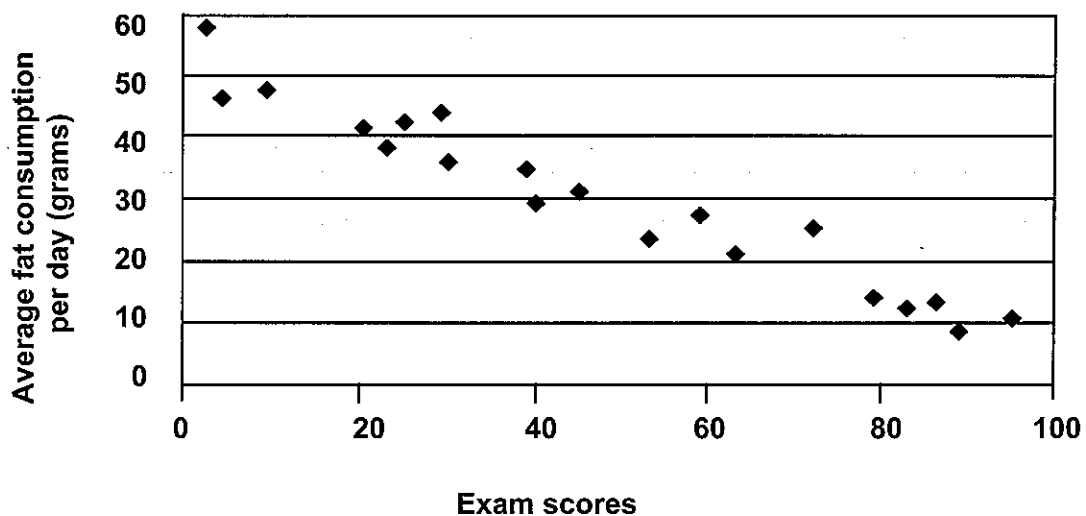
(3 marks)

Question 2

(8 marks)

A psychologist was interested in whether there was a relationship between fat consumption and student exam scores. A study was conducted over 12 months that monitored and recorded the daily fat consumption and student exam scores. The results of the study are shown in the scattergram below.

Scattergram of the relationship between fat consumption and exam scores



- (a) Describe **three** possible relationships for any two variables assessed in a correlational study. (3 marks)

Relationship 1: _____

Relationship 2: _____

Relationship 3: _____

- (b) Identify the strength and direction of the correlation shown in the scattergram above. (2 marks)



- (c) State what the correlation shows about the relationship between fat consumption and exam scores. (2 marks)

- (d) Describe a key distinction between an experiment and a correlational study. (1 mark)

Question 3**(6 marks)**

- (a) How would a psychologist define the term 'privacy'? (1 mark)

- (b) Identify and discuss **two** ethical issues a psychologist must consider when selecting participants to take part in research. (4 marks)

Issue 1: _____

Issue 2: _____

- (c) Sometimes psychologists use deception when conducting research.

When this happens, what action should a psychologist take with the participants at the conclusion of the research? (1 mark)

End of Section One**See next page**

**Section Two: Topic-Related Content****50 Marks**

This section has **five (5)** questions. Attempt **all** questions.

Suggested working time: 90 minutes

Question 4: Cognition**(10 marks)**

- (a) How do psychologists define 'altered state of consciousness'? Give an example of an altered state of consciousness. (2 marks)

Definition: _____

Example: _____

- (b) List and describe **two** psychological techniques that control pain. (4 marks)

Technique 1: _____

Technique 2: _____

- (c) (i) Name **two** aspects of perceptual or visual illusions that can be misjudged consistently over time. (2 marks)

Aspect 1: _____

Aspect 2: _____

- (ii) State **two** reasons why psychologists study illusions. (2 marks)

Reason 1: _____

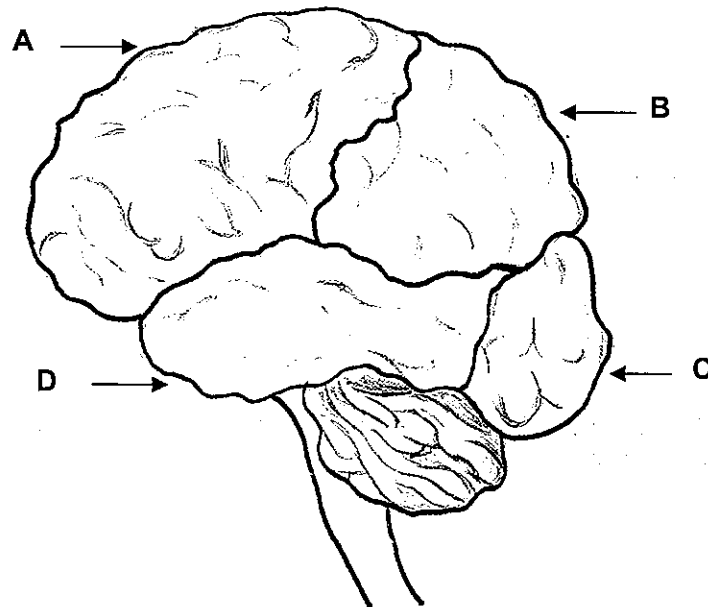
Reason 2: _____



Question 5: Biological influences

(10 marks)

- (a) Using the diagram of the brain below, name the brain lobes labelled A, B, C and D.



Lobe A Name: _____ (1 mark)

Lobe B Name: _____ (1 mark)

Lobe C Name: _____ (1 mark)

Lobe D Name: _____ (1 mark)

- (b) (i) The nervous system is made up of **two** main parts. Name these **two** parts. (2 marks)

Part 1: _____

Part 2: _____

- (ii) Describe the function of the somatic and autonomic nervous systems. (2 marks)

Somatic nervous system: _____

Autonomic nervous system: _____



- (c) Name the **two** processes needed for a synaptic transmission to occur. (2 marks)

Process 1: _____

Process 2: _____

Question 6: Communication

(10 marks)

- (a) List **two** reasons why communication is important in social relationships. (2 marks)

Reason 1: _____

Reason 2: _____

- (b) (i) Robinson discusses three skills that people use in social situations. Identify and explain **one** of these skills. (2 marks)

- (ii) State how the skill identified in (b) (i) may be used in two different cultures. (2 marks)

Culture 1: _____

Culture 2: _____

- (c) In the past, some psychologists proposed that language was innate, while others argued that language was learnt. Discuss the evidence for these two points of view. (4 marks)

Question 7: Social psychology**(10 marks)**

- (a) Identify **two** factors that reduce 'social loafing' in a group situation. (2 marks)

Factor 1: _____

Factor 2: _____

- (b) Describe the impact of 'group cohesion' and 'communication' on group behaviour. (4 marks)

Group cohesion: _____

Communication: _____

- (c) (i) Explain how 'competition' influences group behaviour. (2 marks)

- (ii) Make reference to relevant psychological research to support your answer to (c) (i). (2 marks)

**Question 8: Social values and practice****(10 marks)**

- (a) List **two** examples of issues that may cause conflict because of people's different value systems. (2 marks)

Example 1: _____

Example 2: _____

- (b) Define the terms 'covert influence' and 'overt influence' and give an example of each. (4 marks)

Covert influence: _____

Example: _____

Overt influence: _____

Example: _____

- (c) Explain from a psychological perspective the process a person may go through to make a decision about a social issue. Provide an example to illustrate your answer. (4 marks)

End of Section Two

See next page

Section Three: Extended Response

40 Marks

This section has **two (2)** questions. You must attempt **both** questions.

Suggested working time: 60 minutes

Question 9

Construct an argument, with supporting empirical evidence, to explain how *cognition*, *relationships* and *culture* can influence *behaviour* at school.

In constructing your argument, you should:

- give a clear definition of *behaviour*
- explain how *cognition* can influence behaviour at school
- explain how *relationships* can influence behaviour at school
- explain how *culture* can influence behaviour at school
- consider how these influences interact and impact on behaviour at school
- finish with a conclusion

Marks will be awarded for including references to empirical evidence in your answer. (20 marks)

Use these lines for planning: _____

[illegible]

See next page



Question 10

'Young people between the ages of 18 and 25 years are more likely to be involved in motor vehicle accidents.'

Evaluate the accuracy of this statement with reference to psychological understandings relating to *self*, *others* and *society*.

In your response, you should:

- begin with a broad evaluation of the statement, including definitions of any terms you consider necessary
 - include information related to *self*, *others* and *society*
 - show how these psychological understandings interact
 - finish with a conclusion.
- (20 marks)

Use these lines for planning: _____

End of questions

Check that you have written your Student Number on the front cover of this booklet.